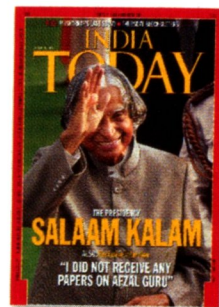


SHIPRA DAS



"Salaam Kalam",
August 6, 2007

"People only look up to the rising sun. By doing a cover story on an outgoing President, the magazine has done an unthinkable."

S. BALAKRISHNAN, *Jamshedpur*

President Perfect

Dr A.P.J. Abdul Kalam's tenure as the country's President has been inspiring. ("Salaam Kalam", August 6). His "mission approach" towards making India a developed nation by 2020 will remain etched in the psyche of millions of his fans.

SIBANI SANKAR SAMANTARAY,
Bhubaneswar

The essay on Kalam was thought-provoking. However, was it necessary to mention that his successor is uninspiring? It was a cheap attempt to malign the new President.

N. BALAKESAVAN, *Mumbai*

The reality is that the hands of the President of the country are bound and he does not have the liberty to overrule the decision of the Union government. And, Kalam's case was no different.

MAN MOHAN BHATIA, *Delhi*

At a time when the country is battling the scourge of radicalisation of various ideologies, votebank politics and pseudo-secularism, Kalam unarguably emerges as the true torchbearer of secularism, perhaps, next only to Gandhi and Nehru.

NALINI VIJAYARAGHAVAN,
Thiruvananthapuram

The nation has lost the services of a great soul due to its mean politicians, who have thwarted the will of the people in a shameless manner.

R.N. KOHLI, *Delhi*

The fact that Kalam is an idol for the Shah Rukh and Himesh Reshammiya-idolising generation, speaks volumes for the man and his achievements. We are going to miss him and his endearing ways.

VIKRAM SOOD, *on e-mail*

In a country where everything is susceptible to politics, a president from a

non-political background came like a whiff of fresh air. And as Chandrababu Naidu put it, Kalam's election as the President of the country was the "defining moment in Indian democracy".

MRIDUL GOGOI, *Guwahati*

Winner Must Prove

Though Pratibha Patil won the elections by a huge margin, the mud-slinging by the Opposition has brought her down from the lofty pedestal Congress supporters would have wanted her to be on ("The Winner Takes It All", August 6). It now remains to be seen whether she will be able to apply a mind of her own while dealing with Government proposals.

ARVIND K. PANDEY, *Allahabad*

She means Business

It is good to see Chief Minister Mayawati living up to her election promise by shoring up law and order in the state

("Cracking the Whip", August 6). The way she has tackled wayward politicians in Uttar Pradesh is a testimony to her professed agenda for the state.

K.R. VENKATA NARASIMHAN,
Bangalore

By being ruthless with people like Dadua and Mukhtar Ansari, Mayawati has done a great service to the people of the country's most populous state. Let's hope that such people do not raise their ugly heads again.

T.S. PATTABHI RAMAN,
Coimbatore

Dadua has been killed. Very good! But why was the administration not able to get him earlier, especially when he had been a BSP supporter? Was he killed because he had stopped supporting Mayawati? There are a lot of questions that are yet to be answered.

SNEHA PILLAI, *on e-mail*